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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEJMC201,

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPJM202 - MEDIA MANAGEMENT

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions. Answer all questions . Each question carries 1 marks

1. Which of the following is a key objective of media management?

b). Achieving organisational goals efficiently.

2. Decision-making in management means:

b). Choosing the best alternative

3. Henri Fayol is best known as the father of:

b). Administrative Management

4. OTT stands for

c). Over-The-Top

5. Which of the following best sums up organizational communication?

b). The structured and unstructured exchange of information within an organization.

6. Which among the following newspapers is owned by a political organisation?

c). Deshabhimani

7. As per the current FDI policy in India, foreign equity in Film and Advertising sector is capped at:

a). 100%

8. Which type of communication is followed when a newsroom editor gives instructions to reporters?

b). Downward communication

9. Which of the following is a major ethical challenge in today's media industry?

b). Fake news and misinformation

10. One challenge of media consolidation is:

d). Reduced diversity of content **[1x10 = 10]**

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions (100 Words). Answer any 10 questions. Each qn carries 3 marks

11. Explain the ways through which media management ensures efficient resource allocation in a media organisation.

Media management ensures efficient resource allocation by engaging in strategic planning to align financial, technological, and human resources with the organization's high-priority goals and audience needs. It uses continuous monitoring and data analytics to evaluate resource utilization, identify bottlenecks, and make necessary adjustments to budgets and personnel assignments, minimizing waste and maximizing return on investment.

12. Define the role of a news editor in a media organization.

The News Editor plays a critical managerial and content-gatekeeping role within a media organization, overseeing the daily production and quality of news content across various platforms (print, broadcast, or digital).

13. Describe the significance of employee motivation in management.

The significance of employee motivation in management is that it serves as the driving force behind organizational performance, translating employee potential into actual productivity and commitment. Motivated employees are more likely to be engaged, work with enthusiasm, and go above and beyond their basic job requirements, which directly impacts the company's success and stability.

14. List three common factors that influence management decisions in media organisations

Three common and critical factors that influence management decisions in media organizations are Economic Pressures, the Target Audience, and the rapid pace of Technological Change.

15. Identify two major economic challenges faced by media organizations operating in international markets.

Some of the major economic challenges faced by media organizations operating in international markets are Currency Fluctuations and Financial Risk, Fragmenting Global Ad Revenue, rapid changes in audience demography due to migration and other reasons, changing preferences etc.

16. What do you mean by chain ownership in media? Give one Indian example.

Chain ownership in media refers to a single company or group owning multiple outlets within the same medium. For example, one corporation might own several different newspapers, a series of radio stations, or a string of television channels across different cities or regions. This pattern allows for centralized control over content, administration, and finance, leading to economies of scale but potentially reducing the diversity of voices. One prominent Indian example of media chain ownership is The Times of India Group (Bennett, Coleman & Co. Ltd.), which owns numerous newspapers like The Times of India, The Economic Times, and Mumbai Mirror across India.

17. Explain how ownership pattern affects the edirorial policy of a media firm.

The ownership pattern of a media firm significantly impacts its editorial policy by determining the ultimate goals, constraints, and ideological lens through which news is selected, framed, and presented. This influence primarily operates through two mechanisms: commercial interests and political or ideological agendas.

18. What is native advertising? Give examples.

Native advertising is a form of paid media designed to seamlessly blend into the content, look, and feel of the platform on which it appears, making it less intrusive than traditional banner or pop-up ads. The goal is to provide valuable, engaging content that matches the user's browsing experience, even though it is fundamentally commercial material, and it is usually required to be clearly labeled as "sponsored" or "promoted."

19. Explain the significance of influencer marketing in social media.

Influencer marketing is highly significant in social media because it leverages the trust and authenticity that content creators (influencers) have built with their dedicated audiences, enabling brands to bypass traditional advertising skepticism and achieve higher levels of engagement and conversion. Buiding trust, highly targeted reach, driving engagement and conversions, competitiveness etc. are some factors.

20. Describe how ownership structure influences financial management in media.

The ownership structure profoundly influences financial management in a media firm by setting the primary financial goals, determining capital-raising strategies, and establishing the risk tolerance and timeline for investment decisions.

21. Explain the role of editors in content management.

The role of editors in content management is to act as the quality assurance gatekeepers and strategic alignment coordinators for all published material, ensuring it is accurate, engaging, and consistent with the organization's goals. Their role involves quality control & copyediting, factual verification and accuracy check, style consistency and enforcement, content strategy alignment etc.

22. Discuss the importance of audience feedback in media industry.

Audience feedback is of paramount importance in the media industry as it serves as a vital, real-time mechanism for market validation, quality control, and strategic decision-making, directly impacting content creation and commercial success. Feedback provides media organizations with the necessary data to align their content and business strategy with consumer demand, ensuring their products remain relevant and financially viable in a competitive market.

Part C

Essay Type Questions (450 Words). Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

23. Explain the major functions of management and discuss their relevance in the functioning of a media house.

Planning: This involves setting the media house's goals and determining the best course of action to achieve them. In a media house, planning means defining editorial direction, deciding on new show/content launches, and creating media campaigns and budgets to maximize audience reach and engagement.

Organizing: This is the function of structuring the workforce and resources. A media house must establish clear departments (e.g., editorial, production, sales) and reporting lines to ensure efficient content creation and timely delivery, especially crucial for fast-paced news cycles.

Staffing: This focuses on hiring, training, compensating, and evaluating the right personnel. For a media house, staffing is critical for securing specialized talent, such as skilled journalists, creative producers, and technical crews, to ensure the quality and credibility of content.

Directing (Leading): This is about guiding, motivating, and supervising employees. In a creative and deadline-driven environment like a media house, directing involves providing leadership, fostering a positive work culture, resolving conflicts, and communicating clear instructions to meet tight broadcast or publication deadlines.

Controlling: This function involves setting performance standards, measuring actual results against those standards, and taking corrective action. A media house uses controlling to monitor audience ratings, analyze website traffic, track advertising revenue, and implement changes to ensure content and financial objectives are consistently met.

24. Discuss why India needs strong laws and rules for foreign investment in media. How do these laws protect culture and national security?

India needs strong laws and rules for foreign investment in media due to the unique, critical role media plays in shaping national discourse, identity, and security, which goes far beyond a typical commercial sector.

- Protecting national security

- Safeguarding editorial independence

- Preserving cultural sovereignty

- Ensuring ideological diversity

- Controlling data

25. Discuss the effects of concentration of media ownership in India. How does it impact competition, diversity, and democracy? Give examples.

- Impact on competition – suppressed competition, vertical integration
- Impact on diversity – homogenization of content, centralised editorial policies, marginalization of niche and investigative content.
- Impact on democracy – erosion of editorial independence, propagation of propaganda
  Examples in the Indian Context - Conglomerate Ownership and Conflict of Interest: The control of major news media networks (like Network18) by large industrial conglomerates (like Reliance Industries) often raises concerns.

26. Assess how data analytics and MIS contribute to content planning and audience targeting in media houses.

Data analytics and the Management Information System (MIS) significantly contribute to content planning by providing real-time insights into audience consumption patterns, such as preferred formats and trending topics, which informs editorial decisions and resource allocation. They help refine audience targeting by segmenting viewers based on granular behavioral data, allowing media houses to tailor content and promotional efforts for maximum engagement and commercial returns.